JJJ-M-576E
December 16, 1975
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. JJJ-M-576d
November 30, 1960

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

MOLASSES, SUGARCANE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for sugarcane molasses for use by all Federal agencies.

1.2 Classification. Sugarcane molasses shall be of the following grades, as specified (see 6.1).

Grade A (Fancy)
Grade B (Choice)
Grade C (Standard)

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-C-29 - Canned Subsistence Items, Packaging and Packing Of.
PPP-G-460 - Glass containers, One Gallon Capacity and Smaller, For Other than Medicinal Products; Packaging and Packing Of.

FSC 8925

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from **Business** Service Centers, at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-L-1497	-	Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078	-	Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-668	-	Sanitary Standards for Food Plants

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

U.S. Department of Health, Education and Welfare

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

U.S. Department of Agriculture

U.S. Standards for Grades of Sugarcane Molasses
U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers
Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables and Related Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

Association of Official Analytical Chemists

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, P.O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, DC 20044).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Sugarcane molasses shall be the clean, edible product, obtained by evaporating the juice of sugarcane and the removal of all or any part of the commercially crystallizable sugar.

3.2 Product requirements. Unless otherwise specified, the interpretation and determination of requirements, including the descriptive terms contained in 1.2, shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Grades of Sugarcane Molasses (and lot inspection and certification tolerances applicable thereto as set forth in the Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables and Related Products) in effect on date of invitation for bids.

3.3 Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4 Workmanship. The product shall be prepared in accordance with part 128 of the Code of Federal Regulations, Title 21, Human Foods; Current Good Manufacturing Practices (Sanitation) in manufacturing, processing, packing or holding. In addition, for Military agencies, the product shall be processed in establishments meeting the requirements of MIL-STD-668.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Pre-acceptance inspection (plant sanitation inspection).

4.2.1 For civil agencies. When specified (see 6.1), inspection of plants producing the product will be conducted upon request of the contracting officer to the appropriate Government inspection agency. Award of contracts will be limited to establishments known to maintain proper sanitary conditions or which have received prior sanitary approval recommended by the inspection agency.

4.2.2 For military agencies. The product shall be rejected if produced in plants not meeting the requirements of 3.4.

4.3 Acceptance inspection.

4.3.1 Condition inspection of containers. When inspection of the product for quality and condition is performed by the U.S. Department of Agriculture, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers shall apply. For applicable criteria governing inspection of containers for the Military (see 4.3.4).

4.3.2 Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.3.3 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification, or applicable purchase document.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20261O-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3.4 Examination of end item. Examination of end item shall be in accordance with table II and 4.3.5 through 4.3.11. Sampling plans and acceptance criteria for table II shall be in accordance with table I. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be expressed as percent defective.

TABLE I. Sampling plans and AQLs

Table	Inspection level	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	AQLs Minor
II	S-3	Primary container	Primary container	2.5

TABLE II. Examination of net weight 1/

Category	Defects
Minor	
201	Net weight more than five percent under specified net weight (applicable to containers required to have a net weight of 454 grams (16 ounces) or less). 2/
202	Net weight more than two percent under specified net weight (applicable to containers required to have a net weight of more than 454 grams (16 ounces)). 3/

1/ Lot shall be rejected if sample data indicate lot average net weight is less than specified net weight.

2/ Calculate to nearest gram (1/8 ounce).

3/ Calculate to nearest gram (3/4 ounce).

4.3.5 External examination for condition of primary container. Primary containers shall be examined in accordance with the criteria contained in the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers. In addition, examination of cans for seam leakage shall be in accordance with the applicable quality assurance provisions of PPP-C-29.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3.6 Examination for grades. Examination shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Grades of Sugarcane Molasses. A lower grade than that specified shall not be acceptable.

4.3.7 Examination of interior can coating. Examination shall be in accordance with the criteria in PPP-C-29.

4.3.8 Examination of shipping containers. Examination shall be in accordance with the applicable quality assurance provisions of PPP-C-29 or PPP-G-460, as applicable.

4.3.9 Examination of unit loads (Military agencies). When unit loads are required, examination of such loads shall be in accordance with MIL-L-35078 and the applicable specification sheet for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1).

4.3.10 Examination of can labeling. Examination of can labeling shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of MIL-L-1497.

4.3.11 Examination of labeling for glass containers. Glass containers shall be examined for labeling in accordance with the criteria contained in the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers.

4.4 Tests. Test procedures and controls which differ from those specified herein, may be used by the supplier if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the Government contracting officer determines that such procedures and controls do not provide, as a minimum, such quality assurance the supplier will use the test procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to test results, the test methods specified herein will govern.

4.4.1 Chemical analysis. Unless otherwise specified, chemical analysis if required by the purchaser, shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists in effect on the date of the invitation for bids or in accordance with methods that give equivalent results.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Cans, levels A, B, and C. Molasses shall be packaged in cans in accordance with the level A, B, or C requirements of PPP-C-29, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.2 Glass containers, level C. Molasses shall be packaged in glass containers in the quantity specified (see 6.1) in a manner to prevent deterioration during shipment from the supply source to the first consuming activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets these requirements.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Cans, levels A, B, and C. Cans shall be packed in a shipping container in accordance with PPP-C-29 for the level specified (see 6.1).

5.2.2 Glass containers, levels B and C. Glass containers shall be packed in a shipping container in accordance with PPP-G-460 for the level specified (see 6.1).

5.3 Unit loads (Military agencies). When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified.

5.4 Labeling and marking.

5.4.1 Cans. Cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497.

5.4.2 Glass containers. Glass containers shall be labeled in accordance with the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

5.4.3 Shipping container. Shipping container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 (Military agencies) or FED-STD-123 (Civil agencies), and with PPP-G-460, as applicable.

5.4.4 Unit load (Military agencies). Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Grades required (see 1.2).
(c) When pre-acceptance inspection is required by Civil agencies (see 4.2.1).
(d) Weight of product required for the level of packaging and packing specified (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) Type and class of unit load required when unit loading is specified (see 5.3).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.2 Destination inspection (for Civil agencies only). When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

6.3 Military agencies. Based on conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, storage and handling of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15, NAVSUPINST 4030.28, AFR 71-6, MCO 4030.14D, or DSAR 4145.7, as applicable.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 45

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC, MS
Dp - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

VA-DMS
HEW-FDA, NIH
AGR-AMS
GSA

Project No. 8925-0114

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 30 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.